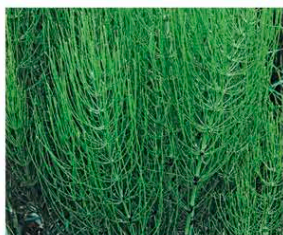


HORSETAILS

COMMON HORSETAIL

Equisetum arvense
F: Equisetaceae

Widespread in the northern hemisphere, this horsetail can be a troublesome weed. Its black underground rhizomes sprout hollow shoots, bearing symmetrical rings of bright green branches.



80 cm/32 in

TRUE FERNS



PILLWORT
Pilularia globulifera
F: Marsileaceae

This marshland fern from W. Europe forms clumps resembling tufts of grass. Its spores develop at ground level, in green capsules shaped like pills.



WATER CLOVER
Marsilea quadrifolia
F: Marsileaceae

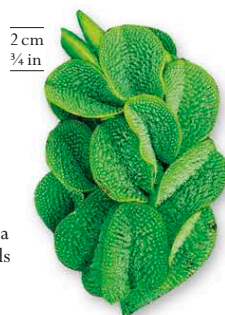
With its four-lobed fronds, this clump-forming aquatic fern looks deceptively like a flowering plant. It is widely distributed across the northern hemisphere.



1.5 m
5 ft

ROYAL FERN
Osmunda regalis
F: Osmundaceae

Often cultivated, this stately fern from the northern hemisphere has a rosette of spreading fronds with several narrower, spore-bearing fronds in the centre.



2 cm
¾ in

FLOATING FERN
Salvinia natans
F: Salviniaceae

Often forming a dense carpet, this water fern has small, oval leaves covered with water-repellent hairs. It is common throughout the tropics.

WHISK FERNS, MOONWORTS, AND ADDER'S TONGUES



60 cm
23½ in

WHISK FERN
Psilotum nudum
F: Psilotaceae

A primitive relative of true ferns, this largely tropical plant has leafless, brush-like stems, bearing berry-like capsules that produce its spores.



30 cm
12 in

ADDER'S TONGUE FERN
Ophioglossum vulgatum
F: Ophioglossaceae

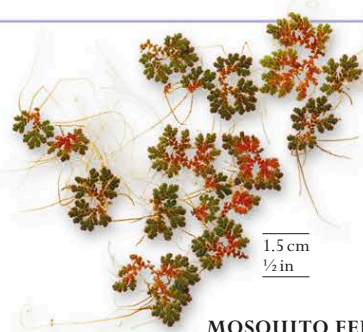
This unusual fern has a single, oval frond, clasping a slender, spore-producing stalk. It grows in grassy places throughout the northern hemisphere.

COMMON MOONWORT

Botrychium lunaria
F: Ophioglossaceae
Found worldwide in temperate regions, moonwort has a single vegetative frond and a fertile frond topped by a cluster of spore capsules.

20 cm
8 in

lobed
vegetative
frond



1.5 cm
½ in

MOSQUITO FERN
Azolla filiculoides
F: Salviniaceae

A floating plant with mat-forming fronds, mosquito fern spreads rapidly across lakes and ponds. It is widespread in warm parts of the world.



1 m
3¼ ft

UMBRELLA FERN
Sticherus cunninghamii
F: Gleicheniaceae

This distinctive fern from New Zealand has a pencil-thin stem topped by a horizontal crown of narrow, radiating fronds. It spreads by creeping rhizomes.



10 m
33 ft



SILVER TREE FERN
Alsophila dealbata
F: Cyatheaceae

This tree fern gets its name from its fronds, which have a silvery underside. Native to New Zealand, it grows in open forest and scrub.



18 m
59 ft

BLACK TREE FERN
Sphaeropteris medullaris
F: Cyatheaceae
From New Zealand, this tall and slender tree fern has a sooty-black trunk and dark leaf stalks, contrasting with its bright green fronds.



8 m
26 ft

SOFT TREE FERN
Alsophila smithii
F: Cyatheaceae
Native to New Zealand and sub-Antarctic islands, this is the most southerly tree fern. It often has a collar of dead fronds hanging beneath its crown.



6 m
20 ft

TASMANIAN TREE FERN
Dicksonia antarctica
F: Dicksoniaceae

This stout-stemmed tree fern is widespread in Tasmania and S.E. Australia. It needs shady conditions, and usually grows among trees.

fronds are evergreen
in mild climates